JAMES RICHARDSON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Principal Engineer with 7 years of hands-on experience building and scaling complex distributed systems in fintech and SaaS environments. I've spent the last three years leading technical strategy at growth-stage companies, mentoring engineering teams, and making architectural decisions that directly impact product reliability and performance. My background spans full-stack development through to infrastructure design, and I'm genuinely interested in solving difficult engineering problems rather than managing for the sake of it.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer

TechVault Solutions

www.techvault.io

Oxford, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Designed and implemented a microservices architecture that reduced system latency by 60% and improved deployment frequency from weekly to daily releases.

Led a team of 5 engineers through a complete migration from monolithic infrastructure to Kubernetes, establishing new CI/CD practices and reducing incident response time by 45%.

Conducted comprehensive system reliability reviews across the platform, identifying and remediating critical vulnerabilities in payment processing pipelines that handled 2 million transactions monthly.

Mentored 3 junior engineers through promotion cycles and established an internal engineering standards documentation that became the foundation for all new projects.

Senior Software Engineer

Momentum Financial Group

www.momentum-fg.co.uk

London, United Kingdom

June 2019 - February 2022

Built and maintained critical trading infrastructure serving 150,000+ daily active users, ensuring 99.95% uptime during volatile market conditions.

Implemented real-time data streaming pipeline using Apache Kafka that reduced reporting latency from 2 hours to under 30 seconds for daily reconciliation processes.

Architected PostgreSQL sharding strategy that allowed the platform to scale from 500GB to 5TB of data while maintaining consistent query performance for analytical workloads.

Championed code review culture and pair programming practices that reduced critical production incidents by 70% over an 18-month period.

Software Engineer

Digital Nexus Ltd

www.digitalnexus.net

Reading, United Kingdom

August 2017 - May 2019

Developed microservices for a SaaS platform serving recruitment agencies, focusing on document processing and candidate matching features used by 200+ organisations.

Optimized database queries and implemented intelligent caching strategies that improved average page load times from 4.2 seconds to 1.1 seconds.

Created comprehensive monitoring and alerting infrastructure using Prometheus and Grafana, enabling the team to detect and respond to issues within minutes rather than hours.

Contributed to cross-functional initiatives to improve system reliability, implementing circuit breakers and retry logic that reduced cascading failures by 80%.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Oxford

Oxford, United Kingdom

Graduated June 2017

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, Java, JavaScript, SQL, Bash

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch

Infrastructure: Kubernetes, Docker, AWS, Terraform, Apache Kafka

Tools and Platforms: Git, Jenkins, GitLab CI, Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack

Architecture: Microservices, Event-driven systems, Distributed systems, Real-time data pipelines

Other: System design, Performance optimization, Incident response, Technical mentoring